

Cache the wrong thing. **Serve stale data.**

IRCTC: WHAT IS WORTH CACHING?

same question from thousands of users

Train list: Delhi → Patna changes once a day	asked 50,000×/hour	CACHE
Seat availability, this train changes every second	asked 50,000×/hour	don't
Your booking history changes rarely	asked once per login	don't

Slow to compute AND often repeated AND stays valid — all three, or don't

- 1 IRCTC train list, Delhi to Patna: changes daily, asked 50,000 times an hour. **Cache it.**
- 2 Live seat availability: asked just as often, but changes **every second**. Never cache.
- 3 Your booking history: barely changes, but asked **once per login**. Not worth it.

REMEMBER THIS

Slow to compute AND often repeated AND stays valid. All three, or don't.